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The Trajectory of Transformations in Contemporary Poetry: From Authorial Intent to the Genesis of Meaning

A Case Study of Mahmoud Darwish's "Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone"

مسار التحولات في القصيدة المعاصرة من دلالة القصد إلى صيرورة المعنى
محمود درويش (لماذا تركت الحصان وحيدا) أنموذجا

Kheira Djerai¹, Lakhdar Bensayah²

¹ PhD Linguistic Sciences Lab, Arts and Languages Faculty, Ammar Thelidji Laghouat University –, Algeria.
k.djerai@lagh-univ.dz

² Professor , Linguistic Sciences Lab, Arts and Languages Faculty, Ammar Thelidji Laghouat University –, Algeria,
lakhdarbensayah@gmail.com

خيرة جراي¹، الأخضر بن السايح²

¹ ط د. كلية الآداب واللغات. جامعة عمار ثليجي – الأغواط، مخبر علوم اللسان،

k.djerai@lagh-univ.dz

² أستاذ التعليم العالي، كلية الآداب واللغات. جامعة عمار ثليجي – الأغواط، مخبر علوم اللسان

lakhdarbensayah@gmail.com

Kheira Djerai, k.djerai@lagh-univ.dz

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Abstract:

Contemporary poetic discourse is the focal point of tension where contradictions converge and homogenates diverge. Poetry is an elusive world that conceals its strategy and does not reveal all its secrets. It is characterized by a more sophisticated level of writing as it expresses a new vision of the world and of thought in an indirect manner, breaking established barriers and traditions. As a result of this change, the poet has employed new mechanisms that contribute to the transformations of meaning. In this research, we analyze the contemporary poet's utilization of these mechanisms and the extent of their impact on the transformations of poetic meaning and the enhancement of its aesthetics.

Keywords: Mahmoud Darwish, contemporary poetry, tradition, the genesis of meaning.

الملخص:

الخطاب الشعري المعاصر هو بؤرة التوتر التي تلتحم فيه المتناقضات ، و تتباعد فيه المتجانسات ، فالشعر عالم مراوغ يخفي استراتيجيته ولا يدلي بكل اسراره . يتميز بمستوى أرق في الكتابة لأنه يعبر عن رؤيا جديدة حول العالم و الفكر بطريقة غير مباشرة كسرت الحواجز و التقاليد المتعارف عليها ، ونتيجة هذا التغيير أدى الى استخدام الشاعر آليات جديدة . تساعد في تحولات المعنى وفي هذا البحث نتناول بالتحليل توظيف الشاعر المعاصر لهذه الآليات ، ومدى انعكاسها على تحولات المعنى الشعري وتعميق جمالياته.

الكلمات المفتاحية: محمود درويش ، الشعر المعاصرة ، التقليد ، صيرورة المعنى

INTRODUCTION

Modernist discourses have witnessed significant developments that have contributed to the reconsideration of multiple issues, including the renewal of form and content. Perhaps poetry has had the largest share of this change and departure from the conventional, being a literary genre known since antiquity. Contemporary poetic discourse is distinguished by a more elevated level of writing because it expresses a new vision of the world and of thought indirectly, having broken the established barriers and traditions of prevailing writing mechanisms.

Contemporary poetry is no longer confined to a single model, nor has it settled on a final form; it exists in a state of continuous change and renewal. It has not submitted to the limits set by classical poetry but has transcended them toward broader and more open horizons. As a result of this change and openness, poetry has employed new writing techniques that extend beyond the boundaries of logic and convention, rendering it a renewed discourse in accordance with a new vision. This

research aims to uncover the latent aspects and nuances of meaning in Mahmoud Darwish's poetry collection, *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?* In our research, we have adopted the descriptive-analytical method to explore the depths of the poetic discourse, in order to penetrate its world and its enigmas. The research is structured as follows: an introduction that addresses the topic and its significance, followed by a discussion of the contemporary poet's use of new writing techniques, and a conclusion presenting the most important findings of the research. The research questions are as follows: What are the features of renewal and change in contemporary poetry? What are the poetic strategies employed by Mahmoud Darwish in his collection *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?* Has the contemporary poem succeeded in achieving transformation and transcendence at the level of meaning?

1. First Subtitle The Trajectory of Transformations in the Contemporary Poem:

Renewal is a natural and necessary phenomenon in every time and place.

Throughout its long course, Arabic poetry has known regenerative phenomena linked to the circumstances and patterns of life. Each time, this renewal has clashed with opposition from conservatives who stood against creative renewal and change; however, all their attempts have ended in failure. Poetry refuses to submit to ready-made models, as it is characterized by dynamism and continuous renewal. Therefore, "the second half of the nineteenth century heralded the emergence of intellectual currents and literary schools of multiple origins and diverse intellectual references, resulting in a corresponding variation in their expressive forms and artistic mechanisms, according to poetic foundations in which their proponents saw the capacity to carry the new experiences of the age that traditional forms were unable to bear."¹

Contemporary discourses have rebelled against established writing traditions through the deliberate breaking of those traditions and conventions. Consequently, contemporary poetic discourse has become a mode of posing questions in thought and knowledge. The strategy of contemporary discourse lies in "rejecting and resisting reality by creating another, parallel and alternative, reality. For discourse has its own reality, which it imposes through its presence and resilience, and its concealment of deep, buried, or hidden significations. Discourse in this sense is a space for free and open interpretation that accepts more than one reading, and is thus transformed into a cultural and cognitive space."²

The contemporary poet has attempted to renew the poem by searching for new subjects to address and new techniques to employ in their expression, in order to accommodate this development and change in life. Thus, the contemporary poem has emerged with a new form, new subjects, and a voice haunted by rejection, transcendence, and rebellion against the ready-made, the old, and the static. The contemporary poet is on a journey in search of an alternative form

and mode of writing that can accommodate their evolving reality in the age of globalization and technology. Thus, creative writing has come to require venturing, a plunging into the unknown, a widening of the horizon³.

In this change and renewal, they found what could embrace their creations and visions, which contributed to the composition of poetic tableaux possessing aesthetic and artistic potentials, with their own particular taste and flavor that distinguishes them from older poems. It also contributed to enriching and maturing their artistic and aesthetic experiences. This renewal was also reflected in the reader, who perceived the transformations of the new writing presented by contemporary poetry, which opened new, more open and profound horizons. Accordingly, the reader's view of poetic discourse changed; they were no longer satisfied with a first reading of the discourse, but found themselves driven to explore its latent aspects and hidden secrets, whetting their appetite for reading from a contemporary perspective, far from the traditional view. "For every age has its contemporary components, and authentic creation is that in which the reader finds contemporary significations in all times and places."⁴

The poem has transitioned from "an art based on realism, linearity, and logical and factual rhetoric that exists a priori, to an art based on questioning, change, development, freedom, and the destabilization of all inherited axioms."⁵

Contemporary poetry places us between the expected and the unexpected, between imagination and reality, between the silence of words and their clamor, between the deconstruction of meanings and the construction of new ones according to a renewed vision, and between the closure of the text and its openness to multiple possibilities. Thus, contemporary poetry has transitioned from the signification of intent to the genesis of meaning.

Contemporary poetic writing seeks to intensify meaning through the following:

1. The transition of contemporary poetry from the signification of intent to the genesis of meaning.
2. The enrichment of language with methods of experimentation, symbolization, and intertextuality.
3. The expansion of the poetic image's signification and its connotative and symbolic power.
4. The transformations of poetic discourse between the openness of forms and creative venturing.
5. The consideration of contemporary poetic discourse as a life renewed by questions.

2. The Charms of Darwishian Poetry and the Latent Aspects of Meaning:

Mahmoud Darwish belongs to the modernist project that relies on philosophy, questioning, and anxiety to create a renewed reality that transcends lived reality. He is "a seer disquieted by knowledge, who donned the certainty of the poem, which has become the poem of knowledge par excellence. He is a poet who was attentive to the anxiety of the poem as it strives toward its deeper meaning."⁶

Contemporary poems have preferred to cast themselves into experimentation, questioning, and the search for the unknown. For contemporary poetry does not answer questions but is rather a question renewed with each new reading and new reader. Poetic discourses are a journey to excavate meanings and open the door to infinite interpretations, "because poetry is nothing but an experience in meaning, an experience in revelation, and an experience in polemic."⁷

Mahmoud Darwish says of meaning, "The text says more and further than what you intended to say, and your saying what you did not intend to say—that is poetry."⁸

Contemporary discourses present us with things similar to what we know and experience in reality, yet they are not identical. This is what has distinguished modernist poetry, which has instilled in the reader a passion for tracing meaning within it and pursuing it in an attempt to grasp it.

Despite this, meaning possesses a mercurial quality that is difficult to capture, "and it remains in its ambiguity despite all the poet's attempts to approach it, because it is not static or fixed but is rather transformative, whether within the poem itself, through a multiplicity of interpretations, or from one poem to another, through the difference in radiant energy between them. Therefore, it is in a state of tension, before the poem and after it; it comes and goes, appears and disappears, manifests and conceals itself."⁹

We will attempt to delve into the transformations of meaning through a study of Mahmoud Darwish's poetry collection, *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?*, which is considered a poetic leap for the poet in that it succeeds in summarizing his poetic experience.

The collection *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?* was published in 1995¹⁰, following the 1993 Oslo Accords. Its poems are not merely words and letters but narratives of the Palestinian tragedy and the meanings of pain, displacement, and exile that it carries. The collection narrates the story of the self and the collective, interweaving narrative, drama, and dialogue to chronicle the tragedy of the land and the human being. The collection constitutes an eternal question passed down through generations in search of the land, the homeland, the family, and the hope of return. The collection is divided into six poetic sections, each containing a number of poems. Preceding these sections, the poet dedicated a single poem, "I See My Ghost Coming from Afar," as an overture to his collection, serving as a visionary outlook on the present and future of the Palestinian people.

1. Icons from the Crystal of the Place
2. The Space of Abel
3. Chaos at the Gate of the Resurrection
4. A Room for a Soliloquy
5. Rain over the Church Tower
6. Close the Scene.

2.1. Language, Linguistic Creativity, and Poetry:

Language is the fundamental tool through which the poet expresses their intellectual and aesthetic vision; words and expressions are their primary means of connecting with the recipient. Consequently, poetic language has received considerable attention from Arab critics and poets. A survey of their literary production reveals a change in the concept and characteristics of poetic language, and in their view of the old poetic lexicon, which no longer satisfied their creative passion or their vision of the world and the experiences of the age. Here, we may apply Bernard Shaw's dictum that "The golden rule is that there are no golden rules."¹¹

If language is a fundamental component and a building block of the contemporary poem, it must necessarily undergo the change that has affected Arabic poetry. "Poetry's departure from the conventional does not mean that it is moving language toward destruction, annihilation, and absurdity. On the contrary, it charges language with renewed semantic energies and continuous efficacy, and creates new expressive possibilities that protect this language from stagnation, entrenchment, and eventual annihilation."¹²

Contemporary language has rebelled against its original lexicon and has begun to say what it was not accustomed to saying before, in accordance with a renewed vision for the discourse, the poet, and the recipient alike. "The language of poetry is connotative; it transcends language to make it say what it does not know."¹³

When language enters the world of poetry, it sheds its lexical garment; it no longer carries that lexical signified but has rebelled against it to create new meanings, connotations, and more dynamic signs. It is the language that compels the reader not to stop at the limits of the word or the image, but rather to hunt for the meaning and its shadows beyond the lexical signified. It is a language in which the creator has left the recipient a participatory role in the search for new meanings and connotations.

This is what contemporary poetic discourse seeks to achieve by "releasing the word—the signifier—from its captivity, liberating it from its conventional origin and its prior fixity, and bringing it to the zero degree of meaning, where it transforms into a free sign charged with absent signifieds and infinite significations."¹⁴

The contemporary poetic language has rebelled against the old system by exploding and tearing apart the conventional linguistic system to grant it more dynamic meanings and latent energies, transcending place, time, and occasion, and transforming poetic discourse into creation and invention.

Mahmoud Darwish utilized contemporary mechanisms of experimentation to shape his poetic language in a way that endows it with richer connotative significations and expressive systems, in order to embody his vision of the Palestinian reality. Mahmoud Darwish sought to express the human being, the homeland, and identity. This is not surprising, for he "inhabited the poem, and constructs a homeland of poetry, draws its borders on the paper's longitudes and latitudes, lays out its land, raises its sky, and forms its topography... so the lines form paths and homes, and the words pebbles and specks of dust, and the poem-land is embodied, with its Jerusalem and its Galilee."¹⁵

It is notable that the majority of the words in the collection *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?* have acquired additional meanings and connotations beyond their lexical signification, thus becoming richer and more profound in their effect on the recipient. For instance, Mahmoud Darwish writes in the poem "From One Sky to its Sister, the Dreamers Cross":

*O butterfly! O sister of yourself, be
as you wish, before my yearning and after
my yearning.
But take me as a brother to your wing, that
my madness may remain
with me, fervent! O butterfly! O mother
of yourself, do not leave me to what the*

artisans have designed

*for me of boxes... Do not leave me!*¹⁶

Thus, the word "butterfly" has acquired meanings and connotations in addition to what it previously held. In this poetic passage, it symbolizes freedom, strength, liberation, and flight. Darwish drew upon these meanings to express his subjective experience, and the repetition of the word "butterfly" underscores the poet's fear of separation and constraints, and his urgent need to soar freely.

Poetic language is characterized by the creation of unfamiliar meanings; words become a flood of significations, narrating a thousand and one stories, and are distinguished by dynamism and renewal. An example is his line:

*He felt for his key as one feels for
one's own limbs, and was reassured. And
said to it*

*as they were crossing a fence of thorns*¹⁷:

The poet portrays the father's solicitude for the key, feeling for it as if it were a limb of his own body. For a Palestinian, the key is not merely a piece of iron but carries far deeper meanings: it symbolizes the homeland, hope, and the eventual return of the right to its owners. The rust on the "key of return," as Palestinians call it, is older than the occupation itself, for it proves the Palestinian's right to their land.

Among the words with a striking presence in the collection are 'the horse' and 'the house'; they are laden with connotative and symbolic significations, bearing a multiplicity of meanings, a testament to their compounded vitality. Mahmoud Darwish writes:

*Why did you leave the horse alone?
To keep the house company, my son,
for houses die when their inhabitants are
absent...*¹⁸

In these poetic lines, the poet highlights the features of the house and its symbolism of steadfastness, patience, and strength, which are reflected in the character of its people. As for the word 'horse,' it symbolizes identity, authenticity, and pride,

and the hope of return to one's land and house. The poet has thus succeeded in liberating language from its lexical constraints and launching it toward the horizons of vision, making the signifier a sign that alludes to compounded energies, aimed at eluding the reader and provoking their astonishment.

2.2. The Poetic Image: Between the Static and the Creative Variable for Accessing the Ascents of Meaning

The poetic image is of paramount importance in literary studies, having become a fundamental focus after scholarship proved incapable of fully encompassing this building block, which expands to reject its singular signification and embrace multiple meanings. The poetic image aims to provoke and elude the reader, ensuring their continued search for its meanings and subjecting the text to the principle of openness. Poets have focused on the poetic image for its crucial role and importance in the poet's vision and the construction of the poem. This interest is not a recent development but dates back to antiquity, as is evident in pre-Islamic poetry, where the Jahili poet excelled in presenting the aesthetics of the image in a simple and direct manner, within the framework of classical rhetoric. Conversely, the contemporary poet has understood the link between the essence of poetry and the poetic image, as both evoke astonishment and break the recipient's horizon of expectation. Poetic creativity can only be achieved through linguistic renewal, by means of innovating new, unfamiliar poetic images. Mahmoud Darwish has leveraged its aesthetic, artistic, and semantic dimensions to form his own poetic language, with the aim of restoring the spirit to the contemporary poem.

With Mahmoud Darwish, the poetic image has another story. It has been imbued with diverse references such as myths, symbols, and intertextuality, becoming the optimal path for accessing the ascents of meaning in contemporary poetry.

1. Symbolic Images: The symbol is one of the tools that Mahmoud Darwish was passionate about, granting it a major role in bearing the burden of the poetic experience within him and conveying it beyond his inner worlds. "Poetry is an elusive world that does not reveal everything, and among its poetic cities is the one marked by the symbol."¹⁹

In Mahmoud Darwish's collection, the symbol has a special importance and a distinctive flavor. Darwish is one of the poets who most extensively employ symbols to serve the Palestinian cause. The poet says in his poem "The Well":

*I will return alive, after hours, from the well
in which
I found neither Joseph nor the fear of his
brothers
of the echoes. Be careful! Here your mother
placed you
near the mouth of the well, and went off to
an incantation...*²⁰

The poem begins with a concise title, "The Well," which carries diverse connotations and meanings that cast their shadow over the entire poem. The poet employed the symbol of the well to return the reader to the story of the prophet Joseph and his brothers, expressing the present day and the complicity of the Arabs and their silence regarding the Palestinian cause.

Among the historical figures the poet employed is Imru' al-Qays, in the poem "A Dispute, a Non-Linguistic One, with Imru' al-Qays," to bestow antiquity and authenticity upon the poetic work and grant it a kind of extension into the past and rootedness in the present, as well as giving the poetic vision a universality that transcends time and place. The poet says:

*Our blood was not speaking into
microphones
that day, the day we leaned on a language
that scattered its heart when it changed its
path. No one
said to Imru' al-Qays: What have you done
to us and to yourself? So go on the path
of Caesar, behind smoke that looms from
time, black. And go on the path*

of Caesar, alone, alone, alone.

*And leave us, here, your language!*²¹

The figure of Imru' al-Qays represents a symbol of eloquence and the language of the ancestors. The poet summoned this figure in these verses to lament the language of this age, which the enemy has tampered with and stripped of its authenticity in order to efface the Palestinian identity. The poet wishes that Imru' al-Qays had left us his language to confront the enemy.

2. The Mythical Image: Through myth, the contemporary poet has sought to embody a world rich with psychological, intellectual, and humanistic significations, and to grant his work an artistic endowment that aspires to a poetic language rich in connotations and suggestions, and to elevate the poet's individual experience to the horizons of the human experience. Among the myths Mahmoud Darwish evokes in his collection *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?* is the myth of Gilgamesh, a heritage myth that speaks of the secret of immortality. The poet says:

*...And I saw that I had fallen
upon myself from the journey of caravans,
near a serpent. I
found no one to complete but my own ghost.
The earth
cast me outside its earth, and my name rings
upon my steps
like a horseshoe: Come closer... that I may
return from this
void to you, O eternal Gilgamesh in your
name!..*²²

Gilgamesh represents a symbol of immortality, as he strove to obtain the herb of immortality, but a serpent ate it. It was then that Gilgamesh realized that the secret of immortality lay not in the herb, but in good deeds. The poet attempts to project the myth of Gilgamesh onto his own psychological state; the immortality he seeks is not worldly, but the immortality of the paradise of bliss with the martyrs who sacrificed for the homeland.

3. Darwishian Poetry: Between the Openness of Forms and the Multiplicity of Meaning

Among the secrets and latent aspects of the language in the collection *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?* is the poet's use of elements of narrative language. He has flavored his poems with the spirit of narrative, such as events, characters, place, time, and dialogue. This transportation of us from the world of poetry to the world of narrative has destabilized the principles and traditions of writing, placing the recipient before an enigma whose codes and talismans they must try to decipher. For contemporary poetry "resembles a dream in its loss of formal logic and the rational, conventional arrangement of things, and the poet condenses the universe to reach the absolute in his language, in which literal signification disappears, and behind it emerge formations and gestures that transcend a single meaning and a single idea."²³

From the very first moment, the collection confronts us with its narrative character, for it alludes to real events. The poet, uprooted from his homeland and condemned to loss and dispersal among nations—this is the inaugural event of the poem and the entire collection (*Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?*, 1995): a journey into the unknown, the story of every Palestinian who has lived the same suffering and tragedy. It is a navigation through the memory of the past, mooring it on the shore of his childhood specifically, his first secret escape with his father in the dead of the dark night, an escape into the unknown. Here, the stage of childhood with its games and laughter ended, and the world of loss was etched in his small eyes, colored with the hues of estrangement and displacement. The poem is a narration of his beginnings, his childhood, his past. From this starting point, the poet narrates a dramatic scene in which he observes his vision and his existential concerns. Mahmoud Darwish says:

*I see my ghost coming from afar...
I look out like a house balcony, upon what I
want.
I look out upon my friends as they carry the
evening's
post: wine and bread,*

*and some novels and records...
I look out upon a seagull, and upon
truckloads of soldiers
changing the trees of this place²⁴.*

Among the most present narrative techniques within Darwishian discourse are the characters, which are considered pillars upon which narration is built in prose works such as the novel, the short story, and the autobiography. However, the openness of literary texts and their interpenetration has led to their encroachment into the poetic work. The poet is not the only character in the text; there are other characters with their own roles, such as the mother, the father, the grandfather, and the grandmother, to whom he dedicated the collection *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?* as he says: "To the memory of the absent: my grandfather, Hussein; my grandmother, Amina; and my father, Salim. And to the one who is present: Huriya, my mother." They are active figures in his real life whose roles were reflected in his poetic achievement, in addition to the enemy, who is the axis of the conflict. It is these characters that control the narrative, in addition to other "literary, historical, and mythical" characters, whose features and symbolic connotations were reflected in his subjective and human experience. The poet narrates for us the image of the father figure as a support in the poem "The Eternity of the Cactus." Mahmoud Darwish says:

*A father says to his son: Do not be afraid.
Do
not be afraid of the whizzing of bullets!
Cling
to the earth to survive! We will survive and
ascend a
mountain in the north, and we will return
when
the soldiers return to their families in the
distance²⁵.*

The presence of the father figure was clear in propelling the course of events and their escalation to a climax, where from the depths of darkness emerges the voice of the father urging his son to hold fast to his homeland and cling to it, bearing the individual concern that was reflected in the

collective concern of the Palestinian people. Through narration, Mahmoud Darwish transports us to another world in which he tells of the tragedy of the exodus from al-Birwa, as sadness drew its curtain over the life of the Palestinian people.

4. CONCLUSION

The conclusion In conclusion, we present a summary of the most significant findings reached by this research:

- ✓ The contemporary poet is on a journey of continuous search, discovery, and renewal, seeking a genesis of meaning unbounded by limits or divisions, which places them in a state of perpetual anxiety, searching for the unknown and the new to satisfy their creative instinct.
- ✓ The contemporary poem is an open space for the genesis of meaning and infinite interpretations, a space where contradictions converge and homogenates diverge—the implicit and the explicit, reality and imagination, movement and stillness—in order to reveal its secrets and transcend the unsaid.
- ✓ Classical discourse is governed by intent, whereas contemporary discourse is open, allowing for a multiplicity of interpretations and readings according to a multiplicity of contexts. Classical poetry answers questions, whereas contemporary poetry poses them; it is a life renewed by questions.
- ✓ In this collection, *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?*, Mahmoud Darwish has succeeded in liberating himself and poetry, and in entering the corridors of narrative by borrowing some of its techniques, thereby making his collection a contemplative vision of reality, the other, and the self.
- ✓ The Darwishian poem carries within it the seeds of its life and its *raison d'être*; it is valid for the past, present, and future, rebelling against the limits of time and space through the genesis of meaning and its openness.
 - ✓ It is impossible to speak of Mahmoud Darwish in isolation from the Palestinian cause. However, what

distinguishes him from other poets is his unique ability to harness his poetry, in its various dimensions, to become a universal discourse, not merely a national issue. The collection *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?* is perhaps the best evidence of this, as it does not end at the borders of the Palestinian homeland, or within a specific temporal period, but is rather a text of open horizons.

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Footnotes

¹⁶ Mahmoud Darwish, *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?*, 106.

¹⁷ Ibid., 32.

¹⁸ Ibid., 34.

¹⁹ Raja' 'Id, *The Language of Poetry: A Reading in Modern Arabic Poetry* (n.p.: Atlas Press, n.d.), 96.

²⁰ Mahmoud Darwish, *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?*, 71.

²¹ Ibid., 158.

²² Ibid., 71.

²³ Raja' 'Id, *The Language of Poetry*, 92.

²⁴ Mahmoud Darwish, *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?*, 11.

²⁵ Ibid., 32.

¹ Kamili Balhaj, *The Influence of Folk Heritage in the Formation of the Contemporary Arabic Poem (A Reading in Components and Origins)* (Damascus: Ittihad al-'Arab Publications, 2004), 12.

² Al-Akhdar bin al-Sayih, *Lectures on Contemporary Literature and Discourse Analysis*, 1st ed. (Laghouat, Algeria: Bin Salem Press, 2013), 23.

³ Muhammad Sabir 'Ubayd, *The Aesthetic Venture of the Poetic Text*, 1st ed. (Beirut: Maktabat Lubnan Nashirun, 2012), 6.

⁴ Asima Darwish, *The Trajectory of Transformations: A Reading in the Poetry of Adonis*, 1st ed. (Lebanon: Dar al-Adab, 1992), 210.

⁵ Al-Akhdar bin al-Sayih, *Lectures on Contemporary Literature and Discourse Analysis*, 240.

⁶ Mahmoud Darwish and the Ascension Beyond Meaning, 1st ed. (Amman: Dar Fada'at, 2015), 15.

⁷ Bahija Masri Idilbi, *Mahmoud Darwish and the Ascension Beyond Meaning*, 14.

⁸ Samih al-Qasim et al., *Mahmoud Darwish, The True Different One: Studies and Testimonies*, 1st ed. (Amman, Jordan: Dar al-Shorouk, 1994), 37.

⁹ Bahija Masri Idilbi, *Mahmoud Darwish and the Ascension Beyond Meaning*, 155.

¹⁰ Mahmoud Darwish, *Why Did You Leave the Horse Alone?* (London: Riad El-Rayyes Books, 1995).

¹¹ Nazik al-Mala'ika, *Shazaya wa Ramad (Splinters and Ash)*, 2nd ed., vol. 2 (Beirut: Dar al-Awda, 1997), 7.

¹² Muhammad Salah Zaki Abu Hamida, *The Poetic Discourse of Mahmoud Darwish: A Stylistic Study*, 1st ed. (Gaza: al-Miqdad Press, 2000), 48.

¹³ Adonis, *An Introduction to Arabic Poetry*, 3rd ed. (Beirut, Lebanon: Dar al-Awda, 1988), 125.

¹⁴ Asima Darwish, *The Trajectory of Transformations*, 81.

¹⁵ I'tidal 'Uthman, *Illuminating the Text*, 1st ed. (Beirut: Dar al-Hadatha, 1988), 155.